

Alec Harrison

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SUMMARY

Staff-level AI engineer and Microsoft MVP (AI) with 8+ years building on Azure and .NET, currently leading generative AI adoption at a \$2B-revenue enterprise. Hands-on with Azure AI Foundry, Semantic Kernel, RAG, and Model Context Protocol (MCP), with \$1M+ in documented cost savings across delivered solutions. LinkedIn Learning instructor, open-source author, and president of Azure user groups reaching 4,000+ engineers.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

AI / ML: Azure AI Foundry, Azure OpenAI, Agent Framework, RAG (Azure AI Search), Document Intelligence, MCP, GitHub Copilot enablement

Languages: C#/.NET, TypeScript/JavaScript, Bash, PowerShell

Cloud & IaC: Azure, Azure DevOps, GitHub, Bicep, ARM, Terraform, Pulumi, Logic Apps, Azure Functions

Frameworks & Testing: .NET Aspire, Angular, EF Core, Swagger/OpenAPI, SpecFlow, Jest, TDD & pair programming

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

LeanTECHniques Des Moines, IA (Remote)

AI Staff Engineer / Technical Consultant Sep 2023 – Present

- **Lead enterprise generative AI adoption** at a \$2B-revenue client: identify high-value use cases, define adoption patterns, and deliver internal AI training across both the client organization and the consultancy.
- **Part classification:** built an Azure AI Foundry + Semantic Kernel system that classified 2M+ legacy parts, saving \$250K–\$500K and 9+ months of manual effort.
- **Contract renewal automation:** delivered a reminder solution (Logic Apps, Document Intelligence, AI Foundry, Teams) preventing lapsed renewals worth \$30K–\$60K each for stakeholders managing 12+ contracts.
- **Knowledge-retention assistant:** built a RAG service (Azure AI Search, Azure OpenAI, Document Intelligence) to capture retiring experts' knowledge, validated against certification exams and unlocking a new revenue stream.
- **Legacy APIs → AI agents:** generated MCP plugins from OpenAPI specs (.NET Aspire, Semantic Kernel, AI Foundry), exposing all legacy APIs to AI and enabling custom Copilots over existing systems.
- Earlier engagement (Sep–Dec 2023): delivered an OTAP project on Azure using TDD and pair programming in .NET and Angular.

LinkedIn Remote

LinkedIn Learning Instructor Sep 2023 – Present

- Created and delivered the Generative AI section of LinkedIn Learning's AI-102 (Azure AI Engineer) certification course, including curriculum design.

Lunavi Omaha, NE (Remote)

Lead Developer Oct 2022 – Sep 2023

- Led a team of 4 nearshore developers capturing legacy system-of-record requirements for an SAP migration.
- Identified gaps in client architecture designs and drove mitigation plans to ensure a robust application rollout.
- Founded the company's Azure advocacy group to train and upskill internal engineers.

Growers Edge Johnston, IA (Remote)

Software Engineering Manager Aug 2021 – Oct 2022

- Managed three direct reports; increased team velocity 50%+ in a single quarter by establishing clear goals and KPIs.
- Designed CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps that cut testing timelines 90% and raised test coverage 70%+ using Jest and SpecFlow.
- Launched a white-label SaaS warranty-tracking platform (.NET MVC, EF Core code-first, Angular Material) on Azure App Service and Static Web Apps.
- Designed robust, budget-conscious cloud architecture; formalized a growth culture through weekly knowledge sharing and quarterly growth goals.

Source Allies Urbandale, IA

Software Consultant May 2018 – Aug 2021

- Built a serverless Azure Functions application that reduced manual data collection 90% and eliminated \$400K+ in data-entry errors.
- Delivered a .NET Core / Angular reporting application that de-risked a seed-hedging process responsible for \$1–2B annually.
- Created the reference template for .NET / EF Core / Angular / IaC projects on Azure, adopted by other teams company-wide.
- Served as lead DevOps consultant: continuous integration in Azure DevOps, cloud lift-and-shift of a monolith, and coordination of offshore test teams.
- Built a React Native mobile application backed by a serverless architecture.
- Founded internal communities of practice for DevOps and Azure, mentoring 5–10 engineers weekly; supported hiring through interview design, interviews, and onboarding.

Software Developer Apprentice Summer 2017

- Rebuilt an e-commerce platform on an agile team using test-first development and pair programming; implemented Django CMS for customer self-service content updates.

University of Nebraska Medical Center Omaha, NE

Lead Microsoft HoloLens Developer Summer 2016

- Developed a CT-imaging application for HoloLens; accepted into the Vuforia beta program and supervised/trained one developer.

OPEN SOURCE & COMMUNITY LEADERSHIP

- **Offline Assist** — open-source VS Code extension on the Marketplace (publisher: AlecHarrison): an offline AI coding assistant / GitHub Copilot alternative.
- **Iowa Microsoft Azure User Group — President (2020–present)**: revived a 350-person group and grew it to 940+ members; formed a 501(c)(3) nonprofit to streamline sponsorships.
- **Omaha Azure User Group — President (2024–present)**: co-organize in-person community events.
- **Kansas City Microsoft Azure Meetup — Leader (2022–present)**: run a user group with a 740+ member list; recruit speakers and sponsors.
- **Azure Cloud Workshops — Co-Leader (2022–present)**: reimaged Microsoft Cloud Workshops as free, public, easy-to-follow labs.
- **Technical blog** — write about Azure, AI tooling, and developer workflows at azurebarista.com.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Iowa State University, College of Engineering — B.S. Computer Engineering Ames, IA • May 2019

- Microsoft MVP in AI • Microsoft MCT • AI-102 • Source Allies Black Belt Award